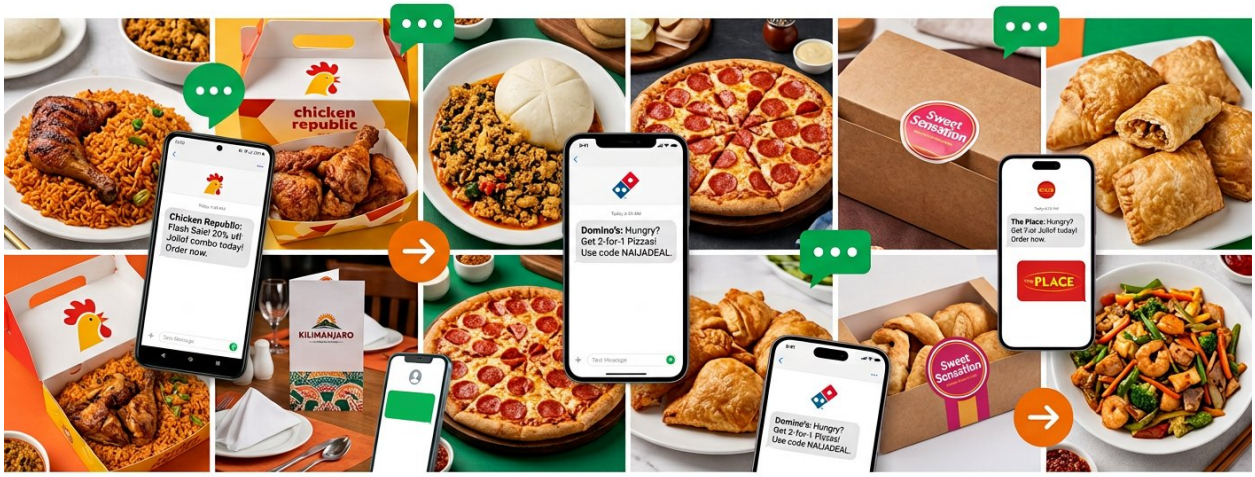
THE NIGERIAN RESTAURANT'S GUIDE TO TO EFFECTIVE SMS MARKETING



SENDERSMS
Restaurant Edition

Complete User Guide & Playbook

Bulk SMS for Nigerian Restaurant Brands • WhatsApp-style Inbox • Templates • Sequences • Campaigns • Scheduling • Analytics

Featuring playbooks for **Chicken Republic** • **Domino's Pizza** • **Sweet Sensation** • **The Place** • **Kilimanjaro** • **Mama Gold** & more
Lagos • Abuja • Port Harcourt • Ibadan • Kano

Version 2.1 — August 2026	**Audience** Restaurant marketers, branch managers, ops
Platform Web (desktop + mobile) + SMS-Gate SIM	**Support** In-app → Settings • hello@sendsms.ng

This guide shows **every screen, every button, and every restaurant-ready template** — so your team can launch a promo blast in under 10 minutes and handle replies like WhatsApp.

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How to use this guide: Read cover-to-cover once, then keep it open in a tab. Every section ends with a **Do this now** checklist. Restaurant examples are ready to copy-paste — just replace the promo code.

Icons: ● Action ● Tip ● Warning ● Restaurant example

1 Welcome — Why SMS still wins for restaurants

Nigerian diners live on their phones, but email is ignored and Instagram DMs disappear. **SMS gets read in under 3 minutes — 98% open rate** — even without data. For a restaurant, that means a Tuesday 11 AM promo can fill tables by 7 PM.

SENDERSMS was built for operators who manage **hundreds of branches and thousands of regulars** — not marketers who love jargon. Every screen works on a Tecno phone the same as a MacBook.

Restaurant Brands You'll See Here

We use six fictional-but-realistic Nigerian restaurant partners as your recipients throughout. Swap in your own names and you're ready:

Brand	Type	Example Locations	Typical Use Case
Chicken Republic	QSR — Chicken & rice	Lekki, Ikeja, Surulere	Weekly promo, new outlet alert
Domino's Pizza	Pizza delivery	Victoria Island, Yaba, Gbagada	Combo deal, late-night push
Sweet Sensation	Fast food & bakery	Ogudu, Festac, Ikoyi	Breakfast combo, cake order
The Place	Restaurant & lounge	Lekki, Wuse, GRA	Friday night live, buffet
Kilimanjaro	Fast food	Port Harcourt, Enugu, Abuja	Student discount, branch opening
Mama Gold	Local & continental	Ibadan, Abeokuta, Ilorin	Soup of the day, bulk order

Result: Every template, sequence and campaign in this guide is pre-filled for these brands — so you can copy, tweak one word, and send.

What you can do in one place

Contacts → Lists → Templates → Sequences → Campaigns → Send → Inbox → Analytics. That’s the whole loop. Most days you'll live in **Send** and **Inbox** (both WhatsApp-style on mobile).

- **Import 5,000 restaurant contacts** from CSV in 30 seconds (phone normalization + deduplication built-in).
- **Personalize** with {{first_name}}, {{business_name}}, {{city}} — no mail-merge pain.
- **Schedule at 9 AM WAT** and go live automatically; watch **Sent / Failed** tabs for proof.
- **Reply like WhatsApp** on your phone — no zooming, no tiny buttons. Unread = green dot + number.
- **Auto-reply** when someone texts “MENU” or “PRICE” while you’re busy.

Do this now: *Open your phone, log in, and check that the dashboard shows your gateway as **Healthy**. If it says “No gateway” go to Settings → Gateway now — nothing else will send.*

2 Quick Start — Launch a promo in 10 minutes

Follow these 8 steps. We’ll use **Chicken Republic — 20% Off Family Feast** as the running example. Total time: ~10 minutes.

#	Step	Do this
1	**Import contacts**	Contacts → Import CSV → Map phone → business_name → city → Add to list ‘Lagos QSR’
2	**Create list**	Lists → Create ‘Lagos QSR – Active’ → Add the imported contacts (or let import auto-add).
3	**Template**	Templates → New → Name: ‘CR Family Feast’ → Paste template below → Save.
4	**Campaign**	Campaigns → New → List: Lagos QSR – Active → Template: CR Family Feast → Validate.
5	**Schedule**	Campaigns → Schedule → Pick tomorrow 11:00 AM (your time) → Schedule.
6	**Send test**	Send → Pick one contact (your number) → Send Now → Check phone.
7	**Monitor**	Campaigns shows Scheduled → Running → Completed. Inbox shows replies.
8	**Reply**	Inbox → Tap chat → Reply. Green bubble = you. Red ‘failed’ shows error; retry from Failed tab.

Template to copy for Quick Start:

```
Hi {{first_name}}! ■ Chicken Republic {{city}} — Family Feast is 20% OFF today only!
4 pcs chicken + chips + 2 drinks = ■8,999 (was ■11,200).
Show this SMS at any Chicken Republic in {{city}}.
Reply MENU for full menu. STOP to opt out.
— Chicken Republic
```

Variables in {{double braces}} are replaced per contact. {{city}} for someone in Lekki becomes “Lekki”. If a field is empty we gracefully skip it.

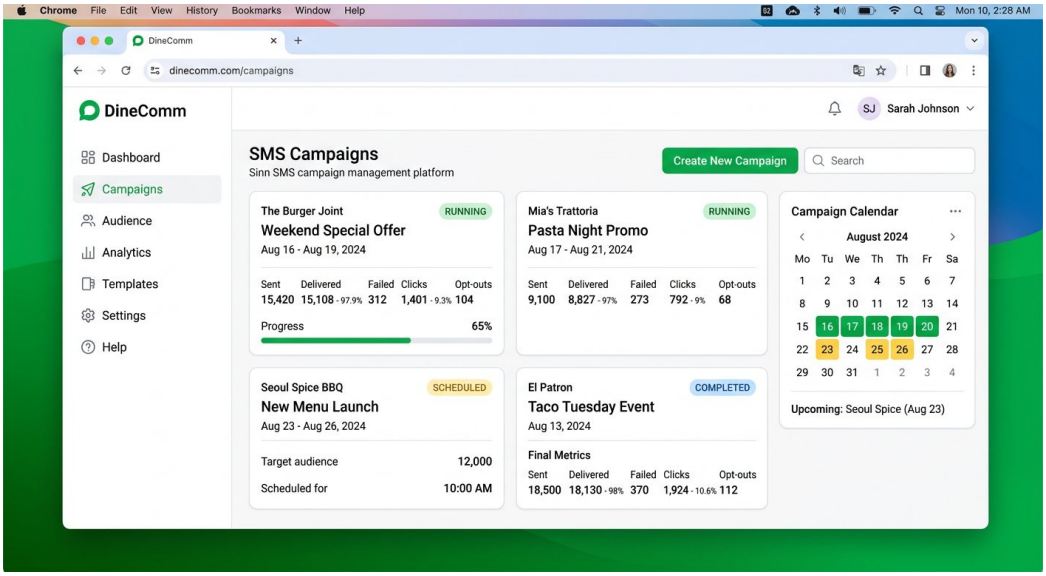


Fig. 2.1 — Campaigns dashboard with Scheduled badge and Send-at time localized to your timezone

3 Dashboard — At a glance

The dashboard answers: **Are we sending? Are people replying? What needs attention today?** It refreshes every time you open it.

Card	What it shows	Restaurant tip
Total Contacts	All contacts ever imported	Aim for 1k per outlet; archive closed branches quarterly
Messages Sent / Delivered	Gateway accepted / network confirmed	Delivered < 90% → check SIM credit / gateway logs
Replies & Interested	People who texted back + marked ★	Interested = hot — call within 1 hour
Active Campaigns	Running / Scheduled right now	Never have 2 scheduled to same list on same day
Follow-ups Due Today	Sequence waits expiring today	Sweet Sensation: Day-3 ‘Did you enjoy?’ nudge

Card	What it shows	Restaurant tip
Gateway Status	Healthy / Unhealthy + last error	If ‘offline’ → Settings → SIM / Credentials

Do this now: *Check “Lead Distribution” pie. If “new” is >70%, you’re importing but not talking. Create a 3-step sequence today.*

4 Contacts — Your restaurant database

A contact is one diner, corporate client, or branch — anyone with a phone. We store NGN numbers as **+234…** but you can type **0803…** everywhere; we normalize automatically.



Fig. 4.1 — Contacts on mobile: WhatsApp-style cards with big Message / Delete buttons — no zoom needed. Desktop shows a table; mobile shows cards.

Mobile vs Desktop

On your phone you see **cards** (avatar + phone + business + slate). On desktop you see a **table**. The data is identical; only the layout changes. Both let you:

- **Search** by name, business (e.g. “Domino’s”), or phone (type 0803 or +234 — both find it).
- **Filter by status**: new → contacted → replied → interested → follow-up → meeting → customer → not_interested / closed.
- **Select multiple** (tap the checkbox circle on avatar) → Delete, Change status, or Add to List in one go.
- **Message** instantly: tap green **Message** → WhatsApp-style composer slides up with live preview → Send. Failed? See red bubble + retry.
- **Delete** with the red trash — confirm once, done.

Importing — CSV that just works

Export from Google Sheets, Excel, or your POS. Required: one column with phones. Optional: first_name, last_name, business_name, city, state, email, website, industry, source.

Steps:

- Contacts → Import → Drop CSV → We auto-detect headers (phone, business, city…) → Adjust mapping if needed → Choose list → Import.
- We show **Imported / Duplicates / Invalid** counts. Duplicates are skipped; invalid numbers are listed with reason.
- Large files? Split to 5k rows per file for faster feedback.

```
first_name,last_name,business_name,phone_number,city,state
Funke, Adebayo, Chicken Republic,08031234567,Lekki,Lagos
Tunde, Okon, Domino's Pizza,08039876543,Victoria Island,Lagos
Aisha, Musa, Mama Gold,08055551234,Ibadan,Oyo
```

Phone normalization examples:

You type	We store	Findable by
08031234567	+2348031234567	0803, 234803, +234…
+2348031234567	+2348031234567	0803…
2348031234567	+2348031234567	0803…
8031234567	+2348031234567	0803…

> ***Do this now:*** *Import 20 test contacts with your own team numbers + 15 real restaurant names (use the CSV above). Search "803" → should find all.*

Warning: Never import lists you didn't collect. Cameroon/UK numbers are accepted for storage but delivery depends on your gateway's international support.

5 Lists — Group by city, brand, or frequency

A list is a named group — e.g. **Lagos QSR – Active (842)**, **Abuja Corporate LUNCH (210)**, **Kilimanjaro Students Enugu (1,430)**. A contact can be in many lists.

Why lists matter for restaurants:

- **Geography:** "Lekki vs Ikeja" — send Ikeja opening promo only to Ikeja contacts.
- **Brand:** Chicken Republic fans vs Domino's pizza lovers — different menus.
- **Recency:** "Visited last 30 days" vs "Lapsed 90 days" — different offers.
- **Value:** Corporate bulk-order clients vs walk-in students.

Creating & managing

- Lists → Create → Name: "Sweet Sensation – Breakfast Club" → View → Add Contacts → Search → tick → Add.
- View a list → see all members → Remove one with trash (does NOT delete contact, just from list).
- Delete a list ≠ delete contacts. Contacts stay; only grouping is removed.

> ***Tip:*** *Name lists like* ***City – Brand – Segment – Size****: e.g.* ***Lagos – All Brands – VIP – 340****. You'll thank yourself at 8 AM when scheduling.*

6 Templates — Restaurant-ready messages with variables

A template is a reusable SMS skeleton with **{{variables}}** that personalize per contact. Save once, reuse in campaigns, sequences, or one-off sends. SMS counts (segments) are shown live.

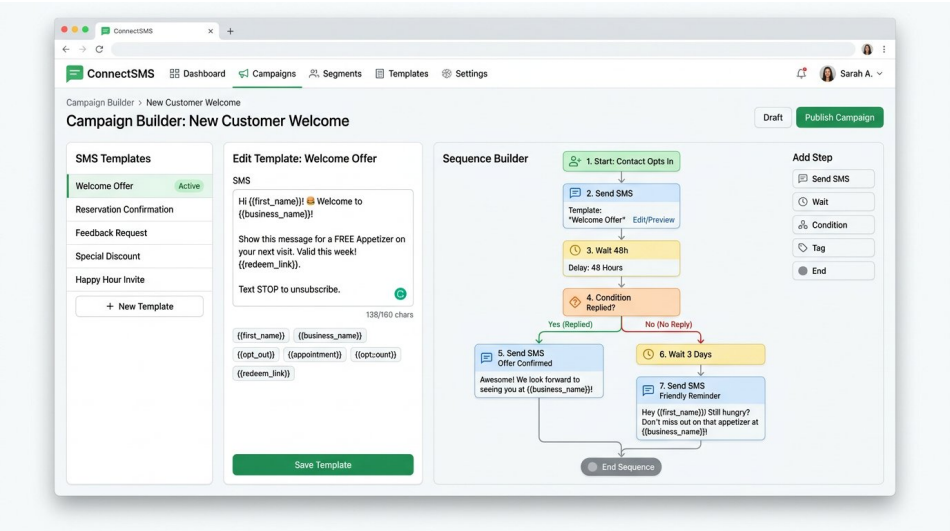


Fig. 6.1 — Template editor & Sequence builder: write once, personalize for every restaurant branch

Variables — your personalization toolkit

Variable	Replaced with	Example (Funke at Chicken Republic Lekki)
{{first_name}}	Contact first name	Funke
{{last_name}}	Last name	Adebayo
{{business_name}}	Business / restaurant name	Chicken Republic
{{city}}	City	Lekki
{{state}}	State	Lagos
{{phone_number}}	Full phone	+2348031234567
{{website}}	Website if stored	https://chicken-republic.com
{{industry}}	Industry tag	QSR

If a field is empty we trim gracefully: “Hi {{first_name}}” when first_name is missing becomes “Hi there” (space collapsed). Always include a fallback like “there” in your copy if many contacts lack names.

Restaurant Template Library — Copy/Paste

All under 160 chars where possible (1 segment = cheapest). Emoji = 1 char but forces UCS-2 (70-char limit). We show segment count live — watch it.

1. Flash Promo (all brands)

“Hi {{first_name}}! ■ {{business_name}} {{city}}: 20% OFF today only — Family Feast ■8,999. Show this SMS. Reply MENU. STOP to opt out.”

134 chars • 1 SMS • ~■4

2. New Branch (Kilimanjaro)

“Hello {{first_name}}, Kilimanjaro now open in {{city}}! ■ Free chapman on first visit this week. {{business_name}} — {{phone_number}}. STOP to stop.”

148 chars • 1 SMS • ~■4

3. Pizza Combo (Domino's)

“Hey {{first_name}}! ■ Domino's {{city}} — Large pizza + 2 drinks = ■9,500 till 9PM. Order: 0700-DOMINOS. STOP opt out.”

118 chars • 1 SMS • ~■4

4. Breakfast Push (Sweet Sensation)

"Good morning {{first_name}}! Sweet Sensation {{city}} — Jollof + Chicken + Drink = ■2,800 till 11AM. Walk in or call {{phone_number}}. STOP."

140 chars • 1 SMS • ~■4

5. Buffet / Lounge (The Place)

"Hi {{first_name}}, The Place {{city}} Friday Buffet is LIVE — ■7,500 all-you-can-eat 7-11PM. Reserve: {{phone_number}}. Reply RESERVE. STOP."

140 chars • 1 SMS • ~■4

6. Corporate Bulk (Mama Gold)

"Hello {{business_name}}, Mama Gold {{city}} handles bulk orders from 20+ packs with free delivery in {{state}}. Quote? Reply BULK. STOP."

136 chars • 1 SMS • ~■4

7. Feedback (all)

"{{first_name}}, enjoyed {{business_name}} {{city}}? Tap to rate 1-5: reply 5=Love it! We read every reply. STOP."

112 chars • 1 SMS • ~■4

8. Re-engage Lapsed

"We miss you, {{first_name}}! ■ {{business_name}} {{city}} — come back & get 15% OFF your next order. Code: COMEBACK15. STOP."

124 chars • 1 SMS • ~■4

9. Birthday (if you store DOB in notes)

"Happy Birthday {{first_name}}! ■ Sweet Sensation {{city}} gifts you ■1,500 OFF cake today. Show ID + this SMS. STOP."

116 chars • 1 SMS • ~■4

> ***Do this now:*** *Create 3 templates: one Promo (1), one Re-engage (8), one Feedback (7). Use Preview with Funke / Chicken Republic / Lekki to see real output.*

Cost warning: One "long" 306-char promo = 2 SMS segments = 2× cost. Keep promos ≤160 where possible. We flag "long messages cost more" automatically.

7 Sequences — Automated follow-ups that feel human

A sequence is a drip: **Send** → **Wait** → **Condition** → **Send/Stop**. The gateway sends the first SMS; the sequence watches for a reply, then decides next step. Perfect for restaurants where the first promo rarely closes — the follow-up does.

Example: Chicken Republic 3-step nudge

Step	Type	Config	What happens
0	send_sms	Template: Flash Promo	11 AM — Send Family Feast promo
1	wait	48 hours	Pause 2 days. If reply → pause sequence
2	condition	contact_replied ?	If YES → Stop (they replied, you handle in Inbox). If NO → next step
3	send_sms	Template: Comeback 15% OFF	Day 3 — Gentle nudge to non-responders
4	wait	72 hours	Wait 3 more days
5	send_sms	Template: Feedback	Day 6 — “Enjoyed us?” — moves to Inbox if they reply
6	stop	—	End. Mark as completed.

Conditions you can branch on:

- **contact_replied** — true if any inbound SMS arrived since last step.
- **contact_did_not_reply** — inverse.
- **message_delivered / message_failed** — after gateway confirms.
- **contact_opted_out** — STOP keyword → auto-stop (compliance).

Sequence tips for restaurants:

- Keep sequences **short (3–4 messages max)**. Lagos diners ignore the 7th nudge.
- Vary the offer: Promo → Reminder → Feedback is better than three discounts.
- Set **wait 48h** minimum between promos; daily pings feel spammy.
- Add a **STOP exit** — opt-out instantly kills pending steps (we do this automatically).
- Clone a winner: Domino’s 2-step pizza sequence cloned for Chicken Republic with one word change.

Do this now: *Create Sequence “CR 3-Step Nudge” with the 7 rows above. Attach it to a campaign (optional) or trigger via API.*

8 Campaigns — Bulk blasts to thousands

A campaign = **List + Message (template or inline body) + optional Sequence + Schedule**. It creates one CampaignContact per list member, then sends in batches of 50 via gateway. Status flows: **draft** → **scheduled** → **running** → **completed** (or paused/stopped/failed).

Lifecycle & controls

Status	What it means	You can do
draft	Being edited; not validated	Edit, change list/message, Delete
scheduled	Validated; waiting for Start time	Edit (returns to draft), Reschedule, Start now
running	Sending batches; polling gateway	Pause, Stop
paused	Temporarily halted	Resume, Stop
completed	All contacts processed	View analytics, Duplicate
stopped	Manually halted	Duplicate to restart
failed	Validation failed at launch	Fix reason, move to draft

Scheduling — precise to the minute

Pick a future time in **your local timezone** (we store UTC). Example: schedule for **Tomorrow 09:00 WAT** → we convert to 08:00 UTC → fire at 09:00 Lagos. A tiny “Will send at…” line confirms.

- Campaigns → New → Choose list (e.g. Lagos QSR) → Write message or pick template → Create Draft → Validate → Schedule → Pick datetime → Schedule.
- Reschedule any time while scheduled. Editing content returns to draft (so you must re-validate).
- Two launch paths: **Celery beat every minute** + **inline poller every 30s** (so Render free tier still fires even if worker sleeps). Only one wins via atomic claim — no double-send.

Duplicating — the smart way to iterate

Duplicate a campaign to get **“Name (Copy)”** with all sending rules (daily/hourly limits, delays, weekend flag) intact but counters reset. Edit the copy, not the running original.

> ***Do this now:*** *Create a draft campaign “CR Family Feast – Lagos – Test” to 10 contacts (your team). Validate → Schedule +5 min → watch it auto-run to Completed. Check Campaign analytics.*

9 Send SMS — One-to-one, bulk & scheduled

Send is for **quick, non-campaign sends** — a single reply, a VIP blast, or a timed push. Campaigns are for large, tracked blasts; Send is for speed.

Modes

Mode	How	Example
Pick Contact	Search → tick 1..n contacts	Send Family Feast to 3 VIP Chicken Republic regulars
Enter Number	Type raw number (080…)	Hot lead from flyer — not yet in contacts
Send to List	Choose a saved list	All 1,430 Kilimanjaro Enugu students

Now vs Schedule

- **Now**: immediate gateway send. We show **Sent / Failed / Total** plus per-recipient error & raw gateway JSON.
- **Schedule**: pick Date + Time (local). We store as UTC, show confirmation. Message sits as **pending** until due, then auto-sends and creates a Message bubble so it appears in Inbox.

Tabs you’ll see after sending

Tab	Source	Shows	Actions
Scheduled	ScheduledMessage pending	All pending futures, soonest first	Cancel (only while pending)
Sent	Message outgoing sent/delivered	Recent successes with delivered check	—
Failed	Message failed + Scheduled failed	Gateway errors, offline SIM, bad number	Retry instantly

Failed? Here’s what to do:

- Open **Failed** → read red error: “Timed out” (gateway), “No credentials” (Settings), “Device offline” (phone app).
- Fix cause → tap ■ **Retry** → we re-send via gateway immediately (new provider ID).
- Scheduled that failed before gateway (opt-out/suppression) also shows — retry moves it to pending → send at next 30s poll.
- Inbox also shows failures as a red “■ failed” bubble inside the chat — so you see context (what you sent to whom).

Timezone warning: *We fixed the old bug where Schedule used hardcoded +01:00. Now we send* ***UTC ISO via toISOString()*** *— so Accra (GMT) and Lagos (WAT) both fire at the local wall time you picked.*

Do this now: *Send → Schedule a “Hello {{first_name}}” to your own number +5 min → switch to Scheduled tab → watch pending → after fire, check Sent (+ inbox bubble) or Failed + Retry.*

10 Inbox — WhatsApp-style replies (mobile-first)



Fig. 10.1 — Inbox: left chat list (avatar, preview, unread green badge) • right WhatsApp bubbles (green = you, white = diner). Mobile shows list OR chat full-screen; desktop shows both. No zoom needed — 16px base, 44px tap targets.

What makes it WhatsApp:

- **Green header (#f0f2f5 / #202c33)** with Sync ■ + diagnostic bug icon.
- **Search bar** — instant filter by name, business, phone, or message preview (Nigerian number variants auto-expanded).
- **Filter chips** (All / Unread / Interested / Closed / Failed) — scroll horizontally, green = active.
- **Chat rows**: 49px avatar (initials), bold name if unread, time (or “Tue” if >24h), green unread circle with count, blue double-check if you replied.
- **Chat view**: WhatsApp #efeae2 doodle background, green outgoing bubbles (#d9fdd3) vs white incoming, tick marks (✓ sent, ✓✓ delivered blue), red “■ failed” under bubble with error.
- **Composer**: rounded white bar + green circular Send (becomes Mic when empty) — thumb-friendly.
- **Stale? No**: auto-polls every 8s; Sync ■ re-registers webhooks & replays history.

Read vs Unread — how it really works

Opening a chat **clears the unread badge** but **preserves labels** (Interested / Closed). We fixed the old bug where every read reset Status to “read” and erased Interested.

Statuses you’ll set:

Action	Conversation →	Contact lead_status →	Meaning
Star ★	interested	interested	Hot lead — prioritize, call soon
ThumbsDown	not_interested	not_interested	Not now — suppress future promos
Archive	closed	closed	Done — no more follow-ups
Mark unread	unread + count=1	—	Remind yourself to reply later

Sync & receive — the full picture

SMS-Gate has **NO endpoint to fetch inbound SMS text**. The ONLY way in is **webhooks** (POST /webhooks {url, event}) + **inbox export** (POST /messages/inbox/export {deviceId, since, until}). That’s why:

- On first install or domain change we auto-register **8 events** (sms:received, sms:sent, delivered, failed, cancelled + mms/data).
- Sync ■ triggers **export of last 7 days** (overlap 10 min) — phone re-fires sms:received webhooks → your inbox backfills.
- Poll-debug (bug icon) checks: PUBLIC_BASE_URL set? Signing secret? Device online? Webhooks registered? Last webhook time?
- Delivery receipts (sent → delivered / failed) arrive via same webhooks and update tick marks.

Do this now: *Open Inbox on your phone (no zoom!). Search “0803” → should still find +234 number. Open a chat → send “Test {{first_name}}” → watch green bubble → tap Sync → see tick go blue if delivered.*

11 Auto-Reply — Instant answers when you're busy

Auto-reply answers inbound SMS **before you see it** — e.g. someone texts “MENU” at 11 PM, they get the menu at 11:00:03 PM, not next morning. Rules are keyword-based with cooldown so you don’t spam a chatter.

How to set up (example: Domino’s MENU)

- Auto-Reply → New Rule → Name: “Domino’s MENU” → Trigger: keyword contains “MENU” → Reply: “Domino’s Menu: Margherita ■4,500, Pepperoni ■5,200, BBQ Chicken ■5,800. Order: 0700-DOMINOS. Reply ORDER.” → Cooldown 4h → Save & Enable.
- Test by texting “MENU” from your second phone → should auto-reply in Inbox as a green bubble marked auto-reply.

Rules we recommend for restaurants:

Keyword	Reply (copy)	Brand
MENU	Our menu: https://... + hot promo line	All
PRICE / HOW MUCH	Price list + ‘Reply ORDER + item’ flow	Kilimanjaro
LOCATION / WHERE	Nearest outlet address + Google Maps link	The Place

Keyword	Reply (copy)	Brand
COMPLAINT	Sorry! ■ DM 080… or reply DETAILS. We fix it in 1h.	Mama Gold
STOP / UNSUBSCRIBE	Auto-handled: opts out + adds to suppression + stops sequences	System (forced)

STOP compliance: Any inbound containing STOP (case-insensitive) instantly opts out, adds to suppression list, sets consent_status=opted_out, and cancels pending follow-ups. We NEVER auto-reply to STOP with promo copy.

Do this now: *Enable 2 rules: MENU and LOCATION. Set cooldown 2h. Test both.*

12 Follow-Ups — Never miss a hot lead

Follow-ups are sequence-driven tasks: **“Send Step 2 to Tunde in 48h unless he replies”**. You see them as cards with due dates; they fire automatically unless cancelled.

You’ll see:

- **Pending** — waiting for its time.
- **Sending** — being processed.
- **Sent** — handed to gateway.
- **Cancelled** — reply or opt-out stopped it.

In Inbox, any reply automatically **cancels all pending follow-ups** for that contact and marks CampaignContact as “replied” so campaign reports a true reply rate (one per contact per campaign, not per “YES YES YES”).

Do this now: *Look at Follow-Ups → Due Today. If overdue >5, create a sequence with shorter waits.*

13 Analytics — What to track & improve

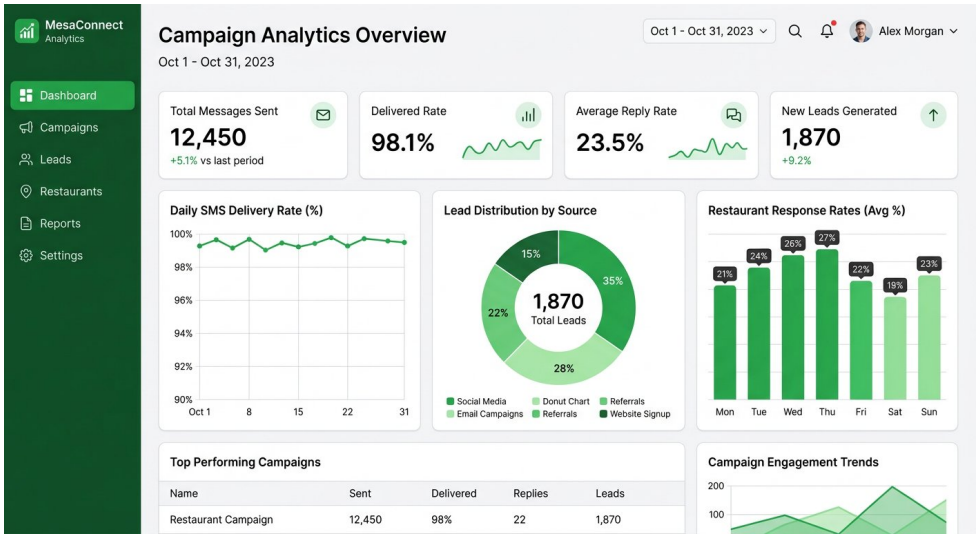


Fig. 13.1 — Analytics: delivery vs reply vs opt-out by day; drill into Campaign analytics for per-contact status

Overview metrics (choose 7 / 30 / 90 days):

Metric	Formula	Restaurant baseline
Delivery Rate	Delivered / Sent	>95% good; <85% check gateway/SIM credit
Reply Rate	Replies / Sent	8–15% promo; 25%+ feedback ask
Interested Rate	Interested / Replies	>60% of replies should become interested
Failed	Gateway rejected	<5% inevitable (bad numbers); >10% = list hygiene
Opt-outs	STOP keywords	<1% per blast; >3% = too frequent / irrelevant

Campaign drill-down adds **contact_status breakdown**: pending, queued, sent, delivered, failed, replied, opted_out — so you know exactly where each diner sits.

> ***Do this now:*** *After your first 100 sends, note delivery & reply rates. If delivered 100% but replies 0%, your copy is wrong — try Template #7 (feedback).*

14 Settings, Gateway & SIM

Gateway = your SMS pipe (SMS-Gate.app). One bad credential = every blast shows 0 delivered. Settings is your health center.

Must-have env vars (Render / Docker):

Variable	Example	Why
SMSGATE_BASE_URL	https://api.sms-gate.app/3rdparty/v1	API root
SMSGATE_USERNAME	your_cloud_username	NOT website login — Cloud Server creds from app
SMSGATE_PASSWORD	…	Same
SMSGATE_WEBHOOK_SECRET	…	From app → Settings → Webhooks → Signing Key
PUBLIC_BASE_URL	https://your-app.onrender.com	So gateway can POST inbound to /api/v1/webhooks/smsgateway
DATABASE_URL	postgresql+asyncpg://…	Postgres (Render free → Upstash rediss needs TLS)
REDIS_URL	redis://… or rediss://…	Celery broker; rediss auto-verifies cert

SIM selection:

If your phone has dual SIM, set **sim_number 1 or 2** in Settings. Scheduled & campaign sends respect this per message.

Webhook health on Settings → Gateway:

- Green “Healthy” = last gateway test succeeded + device online.
- Use “Test Connection” — should be <2s, not a timeout.
- If “PUBLIC_BASE_URL not set” warning appears, inbound will always be 0 — fix it before testing replies.

> ***Do this now:*** *Copy PUBLIC_BASE_URL from your browser bar, paste into env, redeploy, then hit “Test Connection” until Healthy.*

15 Restaurant Brand Playbooks — 6 ready-to-copy campaigns

Steal these. Each is a **List + Templates + Sequence + Schedule line**. Replace the promo price/date and send.

A. Chicken Republic — Weekend Family Feast

List: Lagos – CR Regulars – 2,100 | **Goal:** Fill Saturday lunch

- Template T1 (Fri 11 AM): “Hi {{first_name}}! ■ CR {{city}} Family Feast 20% OFF today+tomm — ■8,999. Show SMS. STOP.”
- Wait 24h
- If not replied → T2 (Sat 9 AM): “Last call {{first_name}} — Feast ends tonight 9PM. 2 extra drinks free if you order before noon!”
- Wait 48h → T3 Feedback: “Enjoyed CR {{city}}? Rate 5=■■■■■”

Schedule: Fri 11:00 WAT, Sat 9:00 WAT | **KPI:** Delivery >96% • Reply >12% • Interested >7%

B. Domino’s Pizza — Late-Night Combo

List: VI + Lekki – Pizza Lovers – 840 | **Goal:** 9 PM–Midnight orders

- T1 (Daily 8 PM): “Hey {{first_name}}! ■ Domino’s {{city}} — Large + 2 drinks ■9,500 till midnight. 0700-DOMINOS. STOP.”
- Condition: if replied “ORDER” → stop (human takes over in Inbox); else wait 3 days → rotate topping promo

Schedule: Daily 20:00 WAT (use recurring campaign via duplicate) | **KPI:** Reply >15% (hungry intent high)

C. Sweet Sensation — Breakfast Club

List: Ogudu + Ikeja – Morning – 560 | **Goal:** 6–11 AM breakfast traffic

- T1 (Weekday 6:30 AM): “Good morning {{first_name}}! ■■ SS {{city}} Breakfast Jollof ■2,800 till 11AM. Walk-in. STOP.”
- Wait 3 days → T2: “Missed breakfast? Try our bakery box ■3,500.”

Schedule: Tue/Thu 06:30 WAT | **KPI:** Reply 8%+ — morning habit

D. The Place — Friday Buffet & Lounge

List: Lekki – Lounge – 430 | **Goal:** Friday 7-11 PM covers

- T1 (Thu 4 PM): “Hi {{first_name}}, The Place {{city}} Friday Buffet LIVE ■7,500 7-11PM. Reserve? Reply RESERVE. STOP.”
- If RESERVE → Auto-reply with Google Maps + “See you 7PM!”
- Fri 10 AM follow-up to non-reservers: “2 tables left! Confirm now.”

Schedule: Thu 16:00 WAT | **KPI:** RESERVE keyword 10%+

E. Kilimanjaro — Campus Opening

List: Enugu – Students – 1,430 | **Goal:** New outlet footfall

- T1 (Opening day 9 AM): “Hello {{first_name}}, Kilimanjaro now open in {{city}}! Free chapman on first visit this week. STOP.”

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- Wait 5 days → T2: “Student ID = 10% OFF this week only. Bring a friend!”

Schedule: Opening day 09:00 WAT | **KPI:** Footfall track via code CHAPMAN

F. Mama Gold — Corporate Bulk & Soup of Day

List: Ibadan – Corporate – 210 | **Goal:** Bulk lunch orders 20+ packs

- T1 (Mon 10 AM): “Hello {{business_name}}, Mama Gold {{city}} handles bulk from 20 packs with free delivery in {{state}}. Reply BULK for quote. STOP.”
- If BULK → Inbox tag interested + manual quote in 1h
- Thu → “Soup of the day: Egusi + Pounded Yam ■2,200. Order till 2PM.”

Schedule: Mon 10:00 WAT | **KPI:** Bulk reply 20%+ = gold

> ***Copy-paste trick:*** *Duplicate a winning campaign → change only template & list. Sending rules (hour limits, weekend flag) stay perfect.*

16 Scheduling & Failed — What happens at 9 AM

Scheduling has two layers — **campaign schedule** (launch a whole blast) and **Send schedule** (one-off message). Both share the same guarantee:

> **If it is pending, you will see it. If it failed, you will know why. If it sent, it is in the chat.**

Timeline for a 9:00 AM scheduled message:

Time	System	What you see
Now	You hit Schedule	Scheduled tab: pending • schedule_at 09:00 WAT (stored UTC 08:00)
08:59	Inline poller (30s) + Beat (1m) both check	Still pending
09:00:15	Earliest poller wins atomic claim → validates → populates contacts → enqueues	Scheduled→ Running → Messages queued
09:00:30	Gateway sends → provider ID returned	Message bubble green “sent” in Inbox; Scheduled status: sent
09:01–09:03	Webhook sms:sent / delivered arrives	Ticks: ✓ → ✓✓ blue; Analytics delivery +1
09:00 if offline	Gateway rejects: device offline / auth	Scheduled→ failed + error ‘Device offline’. Inbox red bubble. Failed tab + Retry button

Failed tab is two sources merged:

- ScheduledMessage failed (never reached gateway: opt-out, suppression, offline) — stored with error text. Retry re-queues for next poll (now +0 s).
- Message failed (reached gateway but rejected: “Timed out”, “No credentials”, bad number) — live Message row with last_error + failed_at. Retry calls gateway again immediately.

You can **cancel** a pending scheduled (only while pending). After it fires you must **retry** rather than cancel — history is immutable for audit.

> ***Do this now:*** *Schedule a message for +2 min, leave this guide open, watch Scheduled → Sent live without refresh (polls every 15s).*

17 Best Practices & Compliance — Stay loved, not blocked

SMS is permission marketing. One angry STOP can cost you. Nigerian NCC + carrier filters punish spam quickly.

Timing

- Restaurants: **11 AM (lunch) & 5 PM (dinner)** get best open. Avoid 8 PM–7 AM — people sleep.
- Weekends: lunch promos Sat 11 AM beat Sunday 9 AM.
- Spacing: **max 2 promos/week** per list. More = opt-out spike.
- Holidays: send **day before** (people plan), not day-of chaos.

Copy that converts

- Front-load value: “20% OFF Family Feast — today only” in first 30 chars (preview).
- One clear CTA: “Reply MENU”, “Show this SMS”, “Call 0700…”. Not three.
- Emoji: 1 max for restaurants (■ ■). More triggers UCS-2 (70-char limit) and looks spammy.
- Always end with **“Reply STOP to opt out”** — builds trust + legal.
- Personalize at least {{first_name}} or {{city}} — lifts reply 25%.

Compliance checklist

- Consent: Only message numbers who gave you their card / filled form / ordered online (and didn’t untick).
- STOP honored instantly — we auto-opt-out and suppress; never re-add manually.
- ID: Sign SMS with brand name (“— Chicken Republic”) so they know who you are.
- Frequency: track opt-out rate per blast; >2% = you over-message.
- Records: keep suppression CSV export for 2 years.

Cost (NGN) — example per segment:

Length	Chars	Segments	Cost (approx)
Single	1–160 (GSM-7)	1	■4
Single Unicode	1–70	1	■4
Multi	161–306	2	■8
Long	307–459	3	■12

Unicode trap: One curly quote ’ or emoji drops limit 160→70. Test with “Preview” counter — if it says “unicode (70/SMS)” trim emoji/curly.

18 Troubleshooting & FAQ

Q: “Campaign stuck at 0 sent”

• Gateway credentials wrong? Settings → Test → should be Healthy.
• List empty? Campaign validation would have blocked — check list member count.
• Check CampaignContacts: pending? → worker sleeping: Inbox Sync also launches due campaigns.

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Q: “Scheduled never sent”

• Was schedule_at in the future (UTC)? We now auto-convert via toISOString; old +01:00 bug fixed.
• Look in Scheduled → Pending: still there? Check error tab. Device offline shows there.
• Inline poller runs every 30s even without Celery — but if ENABLE_INLINE_POLLER=false, you need beat.

Q: “All sends show Failed”

• Tap Failed → read error. Common: “No credentials”, “Timed out” (phone offline), “Invalid number”.
• Check SMSGATE_USERNAME/PASSWORD vs Cloud Server creds (not website login).
• On mobile: open SMS-Gate app → verify device shows Online.

Q: “Inbox empty after Sync”

• PUBLIC_BASE_URL not set → gateway has nowhere to POST → Sync triggers but nothing lands → Debug shows “No webhook”.
• Fix env, redeploy, re-Sync, wait 10s → webhooks land async.

Q: “Ticks stuck on single ✓”

• Sent but not delivered — carrier delay. Poll every 3 min updates via poll_status_for_ids.
• If never delivers after hours, number may be off or DND.

Q: “Import skipped many”

• “Duplicates” = phone already exists (we store +234). Check Invalid = malformed. Copy errors preview.

Q: “Can’t edit running campaign?”

• Frozen for audit: running/paused/completed can’t change message/list. Duplicate it (Copy) and edit copy.

Q: “Message shows STOP but didn’t opt out?”

• Only inbound STOP opts out. Outbound “STOP to opt out” is just text. Inbound detection is case-insensitive.

> ***Need more?*** *In Inbox tap bug icon → “Full diagnostic” copies all checks + last 10 webhooks for support.*

19 Glossary & Support

Term	Meaning
Campaign	Blast to a list; own message + stats.
CampaignContact	One row per (campaign, contact) with status pending→sent/delivered/failed/replied.
ScheduledMessage	One-off timed SMS from Send page; pending→sent/failed/cancelled; becomes Message when fired.
Message	Single bubble in a Conversation (direction incoming/outgoing, status queued→sent→delivered/failed).
Conversation	One thread per contact (Unique contact_id); shows unread count, last preview.
Template	Reusable body with {{variables}}; versioned via sequence_version snapshot if used in campaign.
Sequence / FollowUp	Drip automation; FollowUp is the scheduled next step with scheduled_at.
Gateway	SMS-Gate provider; credentials + webhook secret + deviceId.

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Term	Meaning
Suppression	Global blocklist for STOP/opt-out; checked before every send.
Idempotency Key	Unique per message to dedupe webhook replays (e.g. inbound-V2).

Channel	How	When
In-app Help	Settings → Support / Docs	Always
Email	hello@sendsms.ng	9 AM–6 PM WAT
Phone	Via gateway SIM (your device)	For gateway troubleshooting

You’re ready. Import your restaurant contacts, copy one template, schedule for tomorrow 11 AM, and reply like WhatsApp. Your guests are hungry — tell them what’s cooking. ■■

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